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Title:

Everything Bagel

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EVERYTHING BAGEL

A 10-minute play

Written by

Cam Eickmeyer

CAST OF CHARACTERS:

Young Man: 20s, full of life and energy, ready to conquer the world

Old Man: 80s, tired and grumpy, perfectly happy to spend the day in the recliner watching old movies

Son: Late 50s, bogged down by obligations and not pleased to be stuck managing his aging father

*Note: All roles can be changed to any gender. Nothing in the story is male specific.

SCENE:

Small apartment

TIME:

Present day

AT RISE:

Setting: Small apartment with minimal furniture. A recliner, small breakfast table with two chairs, and a wheelchair.

At Rise: YOUNG MAN fidgets and bounces impatiently. He's eager to start the day and something off stage is slowing him down.

(Something catches his attention off stage, he takes a few steps forward eagerly)

YOUNG MAN
Are you awake?

OLD MAN
(Off stage)
Yes, are you happy? You couldn't let me sleep a little more?

YOUNG MAN
All you *do* is sleep. Sleep when you're dead.

(OLD MAN enters. He limps and shuffles, dragging a wheeled oxygen tank carefully across the room to his easy chair where he plops down.)

OLD MAN
You promise to let me sleep when I'm dead?

YOUNG MAN
To be determined.

OLD MAN
You're on my last nerve, roomie, and it's not even breakfast.

YOUNG MAN
Breakfast is a wonderful idea. Where should we go?

OLD MAN
Go? I just sat down!

(Young Man bounces around with excitement. He shakes the chair playfully)

YOUNG MAN
Then stand back up. Get in the wheelchair if you have to, let's go out for breakfast.

OLD MAN
And where would we go? The odd couple's corner cafe?

YOUNG MAN
What's the name of that bagel shop you used to love?

(They both tap their temples trying to jog their memories)

OLD MAN
Something with a C

YOUNG MAN
Colleen's? Cormica's? Cirrillo's?

OLD MAN
Are you just saying random names to confuse me?

YOUNG MAN
Capricorn, Candy corn, corn on the cob

OLD MAN
You are a real pain sometimes.

YOUNG MAN
Camille's Deli! That's it

OLD MAN
Camille's, yeah, that was it

YOUNG MAN
See? There's a method to my madness

OLD MAN
Emphasis on the ***madness***

YOUNG MAN
Let's go to Camille's for everything bagels with coffee.

OLD MAN
Camille's has to be five miles away, we can't walk there

YOUNG MAN
So we take a bus

(Old Man chuckles at the youthful exuberance)

OLD MAN
We just hop on a bus with my wheelchair and oxygen tank and head off to Camille's, that it?

YOUNG MAN
Why not? Picture the blanket of egg and cheese on a slice of Taylor Ham, all tucked perfectly into a toasted bagel.

OLD MAN
Got a cup of coffee in that fantasy?

YOUNG MAN
Two creams, two sugars just the way you like it

OLD MAN
Ha! That's the way *you* like it. *I* like it black.

YOUNG MAN
Fine, black and strong. However you want, **let's just go**.

OLD MAN
You're pretty serious about an everything bagel today

YOUNG MAN
And the coffee. Can't forget the coffee

OLD MAN
What has your pants on fire?

YOUNG MAN
Adventure!

OLD MAN
Adventure? You don't think sitting in a recliner watching old movies counts?

YOUNG MAN
We have money, you are stronger than you think. Let's *just* ***go***. We can go anywhere. Think big. Fly to Los Angeles, go to Disneyland, fly to New Orleans and party in the French Quarter. Oh, I've got it!
(MORE)

YOUNG MAN (CONT'D)
We fly to Paris, eat baguettes under the Eiffel tower.

OLD MAN
You and bread seem to have a thing today.

YOUNG MAN
The Grand Canyon! It's been at least ten years since you've been there, right? We'll take a mule ride to the bottom.

OLD MAN
Did you find a bottle of liquor or something? You think I can ride a mule and sleep on the ground? Did they install a fancy hotel in the Grand Canyon or something?

YOUNG MAN
Think ***bigger*** than this room.

OLD MAN
You forget about my broken down body.

YOUNG MAN
Pain is temporary, everything bagels are forever. You can sleep-

OLD MAN
When I'm dead, yeah I remember.

YOUNG MAN
Let's go. If not Paris or the Canyon, let's make it to Camille's. Something beyond this room.

(Old Man pauses, he's on the verge of giving in when SON enters carrying a food tray. On the tray is a covered plate and two paper cups)

SON
Hi Dad. How you feeling?

(Young Man doesn't like Son and crosses opposite stage in a huff)

OLD MAN
I was talking about breakfast.

SON
Perfect timing then, eh? Looks good today I think.

(Son removes the lid on the plate and shows it to Old Man like it's fine dining. Young Man peers over skeptically)

YOUNG MAN
Gross. Is that supposed to be a scrambled egg?

OLD MAN
Got any bagels?

SON
No, dad. Like I said last time, they don't have bagels here.

YOUNG MAN
Can you imagine how a bagel would taste in this place? Lets get out of here while we still can. Everything bagel, Taylor ham-

OLD MAN
Coffee

SON
Coffee I can help you with after you take your pills.

(Young Man recoils in fear)

YOUNG MAN
Don't take them, please. I feel fine for the first time in a while. **DON'T DO IT.**

(Old Man stares at the cup of pills and hesitates)

OLD MAN
So many pills.

SON
Look Dad, it's the same thing every day. The nurse told me you are fighting them about the meds so I promised you'd take them today.

YOUNG MAN
Please! You don't need those.

OLD MAN
I hurt so bad sometimes.

SON
Yep, so take the meds. It'll help.

YOUNG MAN
You do that and you can kiss Paris goodbye. Come on! Let's go, jump in your wheelchair, I'll help.

OLD MAN
How are you going to push the chair?

SON
You want to go somewhere Dad? Then take the meds.

YOUNG MAN
I'm begging you, please! I'm ***dying***.

OLD MAN
I *know*, I know.

(Old Man tips the contents of one cup into his mouth, then the water cup to swallow the pills)

SON
That's it. Thanks. I'll be back with that coffee.

(Old Man looks over at Young Man who sulks with his back turned. Old Man raises his hand to his Son.)

OLD MAN
Maybe I can have coffee on the patio today?

(Son lets out a heavy sigh, this request is apparently a large burden)

SON
I'll see what I can do.

(Son exits. Young Man sits down at the table in despair)

OLD MAN
I had to do it. Just a little relief for this pain.

YOUNG MAN
I'm not in pain though.

OLD MAN
Maybe tomorrow we can go for bagels.

(MORE)

OLD MAN (CONT'D)
Today we can sit in the sun a bit. That's pretty good still right?

(As the medicine begins to kick in, Old Man gains some mobility, but Young Man shrinks away)

YOUNG MAN
You used to want adventure.

OLD MAN
Adventure is in the eye of the beholder.

YOUNG MAN
What does it matter anyway? Eat your eggs.

OLD MAN
He said he would ask about the bagels.

YOUNG MAN
Who said?

OLD MAN
The guy, you know, the guy who comes-

YOUNG MAN
What's his *name*?

OLD MAN
Don't do that to me.

YOUNG MAN
What's his ***name***?

OLD MAN
I said stop it-

YOUNG MAN
You don't know your own son's name. You can't dream about Paris and the Grand Canyon, but **I** still can. *I'm still in here*. Don't let me **die**.

(The last burst of anger takes the rest of Young Man's energy. He starts to slump, to shut down, to fade away)

OLD MAN
I'm not letting you die. I just need some rest. Then maybe we can go get a bagel.

YOUNG MAN
We won't.

OLD MAN
Everything bagel and coffee, just like you want. Just a little nap is all, maybe some sun. I'll feel better.

(Old Man falls asleep in his chair. Young Man rests his head in his hands. They're only asleep for a moment, then again it's hard to say how time passes in these sorts of places. Son enters without warning and pulls the wheelchair next to the recliner)

SON
Hey Dad? Dad? Wake up. I only have about a half hour so if we're gonna go for a walk we have to leave *now*.

(Old Man looks at Young Man, who is still motionless in the chair. Son helps Old Man into the wheelchair as they speak.)

OLD MAN
I was going to have some coffee.

SON
Yeah dad, I know. Look, it's raining so we'll just have to go down to the dining hall instead OK? Maybe look out the window at the parking lot?

OLD MAN
Everything bagel with egg and cheese and-

SON
You can't have Taylor Ham anymore dad, bad for your cholesterol. Every visit it's everything bagels and coffee. Camille's closed twenty years ago and that was in *Jersey*. You're in *Arizona* now.

OLD MAN
Colleen's? Cormica's? Cirrillo's?

SON
Camille, dad. Camille's Deli. Look Dad, can we not argue today? Let's get some coffee and watch the cars OK? It's better than sitting in this room right?

(Old Man looks toward Young Man one last time. Young Man still isn't moving. If he's not already gone, he's very close to the end.)

OLD MAN
Maybe bagels tomorrow?

SON
Sure Dad, maybe bagels tomorrow.

(Son wheels Old Man off stage)

THE END